



SHARING SESSION

A green recovery – Affordable housing for vulnerable families and resilient livelihoods using CSEB interlocking bricks in Nepal.

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Image Courtesy: Build Up Nepal

Compressed stabilized earth brick (CSEB) interlocking brick has been manufactured by rural entrepreneurs supported by Build Up Nepal. Interlocking Brick Technology consists of specially designed unburnt bricks with lock and key features that allow bricks to interlock each other in masonry and thereby reduces mortar usage. Construction with interlocking bricks is economical, quick and environment friendly. Special design of interlocking bricks allows for vertical reinforcement bars in strategic locations of buildings. The CSEB manufacturing machine costs around NPR 235,000 - 365,000 (depending on model) and the cost of one CSEB block is about NPR 45-50 (1 CSEB = 4 fired bricks in size). Besides the cost of the brick, it also significantly reduces the amount of cement and labour used in construction. **Photo Credit: Build Up Nepal**

HIGHLIGHTS

- Invitation to a Webinar session on affordable housing for vulnerable households using compressed stabilized earth brick (CSEB) interlocking brick scheduled for 02 October
- HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey (PSS) results:
- National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) Steering Committee recommends for a year extension of NRA mandate
- House Cost Calculator uploaded on the website for public use
- The Urban Recovery Technical Working Group (UR-TWG) update
- Asia Shelter Forum Organizing Committee Meeting update
- Bagmati Province Shelter Cluster Meeting update

FEATURED TECHNICAL STAFF STORY: Anupa Basnet, Financial Management Specialist



Anupa Basnet

*Financial Management Specialist
Kathmandu*

Anupa Basnet, has been serving as a Finance Management Specialist for Earthquake Housing Reconstruction Projects at CLPIU under National Reconstruction Authority since 2018.

When she took charge as Finance Management Specialist, the government was often criticized for the lengthy grant distribution process, delay payment, double payment, and many more.

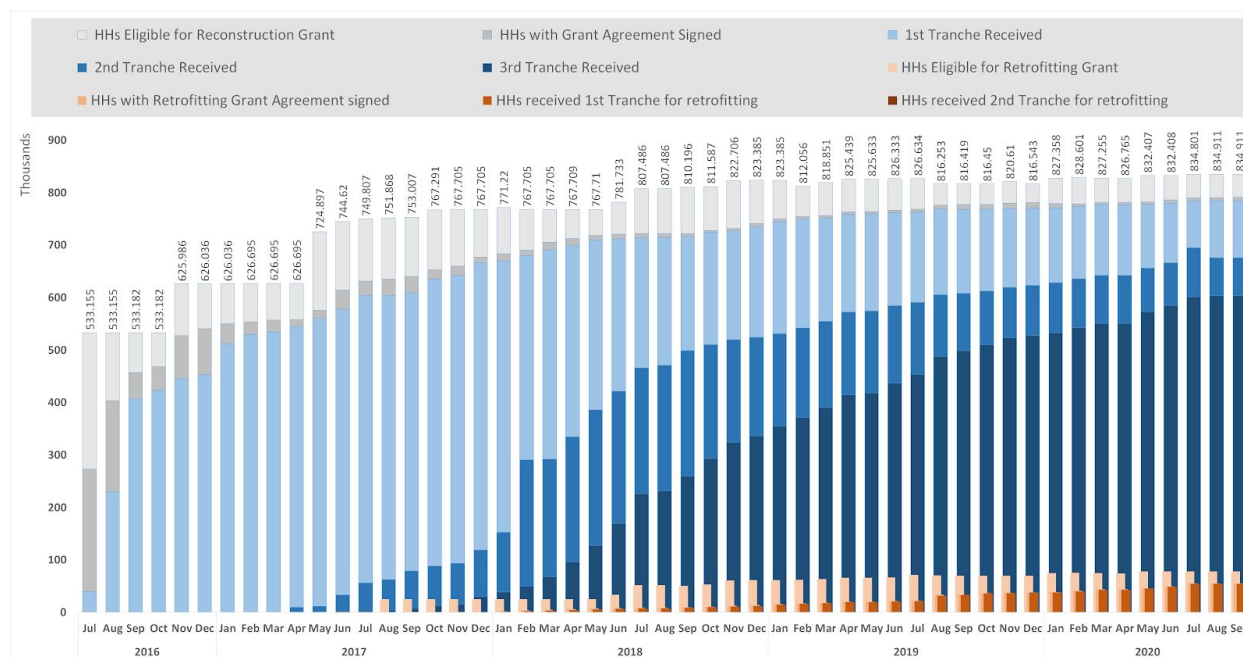
The hard work and dedication of her team to reach out to the distressed and vulnerable community affected by the earthquake have resulted positively due to which the grant payment process is on pace and banks are uploading payment data in the NRA MIS system on time.

NATIONAL UPDATES

NRA, CLPIU GMaLI and Building. Grant Disbursement Data, as of 28 September 2020:

Reconstruction Grant	27 July	31 August	28 September
Total No. Eligible HHs	834801	834911	834911
HHs Enrolled	789926	790260	791334
HHs Received 1st Tranche	784283	784520	784535
HHs Applied for 2nd Tranche	N/A	N/A	N/A
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	694360	675454	675457
Non-complaint at 2nd Tranche	N/A	N/A	N/A
HHs Applied for 3rd Tranche	N/A	N/A	N/A
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	601272	603550	603551
Non-complaint at 3rd Tranche	N/A	N/A	N/A
Houses Completed	N/A	N/A	N/A
HHs with Completion Certificate	N/A	N/A	N/A
Retrofit Grant	27 July	31 August	28 September
Total No. Eligible HHs	77999	78033	78033
HHs Enrolled	54818	55051	55282
HHs Received 1st Tranche	54260	54466	54497
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	300	302	302

**N/A indicates that the information source was not accessible at the time of reporting*



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMAI CLPIU data as of 28 Sep 2020.

Invitation to a Webinar session on affordable housing for vulnerable households using compressed stabilized earth brick (CSEB) interlocking brick scheduled for 02 October: HRRP in collaboration with Build up Nepal Engineering, Dan Church Aid (DCA), Practical Action & Community Impact Nepal is planning a Webinar Session on **02 October 2020; 03:00 - 04:15 PM, (GMT +5:45)** Nepal time on the subject “A green recovery - Affordable housing for vulnerable families and resilient livelihoods using CSEB interlocking bricks in Nepal”. The experts on the subject matter including grassroots entrepreneurs will be presenting on the advantage of CSEB Interlocking block and low cost housing models in support of vulnerable beneficiaries in all the earthquake-affected areas. Please register in advance for this webinar: <https://forms.gle/FixobFyNtbNCDjuX7>. For more information on the webinar, please contact info@hrrpnepal.org

HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey (PSS) results: HRRP conducted its fourth phase (August 2019- July 2021) Partner Satisfaction Survey (PSS) during the month of July-August 2020, with the objective of gathering feedback on HRRP activities, to assess how HRRP is working with its partners, and get to understand the perception of stakeholders involved

in the platform. Click [here](#) to read the findings from the the survey results from the total 192 PSS respondents comprised of GoN (75%); INGOs (10%) and NGOs (9%) followed by UN (2%) and Private Sector (2%), Donors (1%) and others (1%).

House Cost Calculator: The House Cost-Technical Working Group (CRS, NSET & HRRP) including PIN, PA, Build Up Nepal and various other partners have devised a house cost calculator app which is able to calculate the approximate housing cost including the transportation and material cost for building a house as per the norms and design in the catalogue from NRA. The system has been made available as a beta version to the engineers and general public. The web application can be accessed from the following domain for public use. Site address: <https://www.housecostcalculator.app/>

The application will soon be launched in the android version as well and will be available in the Google Play Store for downloads once the testing of the mobile application has been completed. For more information on this, please contact: info@hrrpnepal.org

National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) Steering Committee recommends for one year extension of NRA mandate, 21 September 2020

The National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) Steering Committee meeting, held on 21 September 2020, has decided to recommend a year extension of the NRA mandate to the Council of Ministers. The current mandate is expiring in December 2020. According to the NRA source of information, the mandate has been extended until the end of Asar 2078 (mid July 2021). During the extension period, NRA will focus on the regular reconstruction work for 6.5 months whereas remaining 5 months and 10 days will be focused on financial auditing, including hand over of the remaining reconstruction work, and reconstruction documents to local governments. The NRA will also organize an international conference on Nepal's reconstruction (ICNR) including support to National Disaster Risk Reduction Management Authority (NDRRMA) for the resettlement of Sindhupalchowk landslide affected households.

Asia Shelter Forum Organizing Committee Meeting held on 22 September, 2020

On 22 September, Asia Shelter Forum Organizing Committee meeting was held through Zoom, to discuss the virtual and abridged session coinciding with the NRA compendium

Presentation planned from 27-29 November 2020. The Asia Shelter Forum Organizing Committee is working on the concept note along with a program agenda to integrate Asia Shelter Forum with NRA Compendium Presentation as one event. The program agenda will be finalized soon after the approval from the NRA Executive level meeting for sharing with partners.

For more information, please contact Minar Thapa Magar (National Coordinator-General Coordination) minar@hrrpnepal.org

A virtual meeting on urban housing recovery issues held, 11 September, 2020

A virtual meeting was organised on “Urban Housing Recovery Issues” between NRA, MoUD and HRRP on 11 September 2020. The meeting was hosted by NRA to discuss urban housing recovery issues which emerged from the NRA/HRRP study and research papers presented during the National Symposium on Nepal’s Reconstruction (NSNR), particularly on issues of land, access to finance, retrofitting, houses in heritage settlements, and creation of housing database for effective implementation. In the meeting, Ms. Bhubaneswari Parajuli (HRRP-National Technical Coordinator) presented on “Urban Housing Recovery Issues & Recommendations for Policy Reform” followed by another presentation by Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha (NRA- Executive Member) on “Taking Forward NRA’s Lessons in Urban Sector”. The presentations were followed by a plenary discussion, where officials from NRA and MoUD commented on issues and challenges in urban housing recovery. The Chief Executive Officer of NRA, Mr. Sushil Gyawali highlighted challenges pertaining to policy implications and operational challenges that need to be addressed for urban housing recovery. He stressed on the need for larger collaboration with local level governments to resolve the remaining challenges and further acknowledged that wider consultation with key stakeholders is necessary to address urban recovery.

The Urban Recovery Technical Working Group (UR-TWG) update:

The UR-TWG held its 16th meeting on 17 September, 2020. The agenda of the meeting was: a) Status update of Urban Quantitative Survey and further steps b) Update on virtual meeting between NRA, MoUD and HRRP c) Sharing on Community-led post-earthquake heritage reconstruction and its implication on settlement-level recovery plans d) sharing of

progress and updates in urban recovery by UR-TWG members. The data collection for urban quantitative survey is complete and the process of data analysis is ongoing. During the virtual meeting held on September 11th 2020 hosted by NRA, discussions were based on urban housing recovery issues which emerged from the NRA/HRRP study and NSNR Symposium. This was followed with a presentation from Mr. Rupesh Shrestha (Urban Coordination Officer from HRRP Nepal), who presented his research on community-led heritage reconstruction and how communities can be engaged for settlement-level recovery.

Bagmati Province Shelter Cluster update, 10 September 2020:

The Second virtual meeting of the Bagmati Province Shelter Cluster was organized on 10 September 2020. The meeting focused on COVID-19 threats, status and gaps in isolation and quarantine facilities, monsoon risks and major disaster challenges at Sindhupalchok, Nuwakot, Chitwan and other affected districts. Participants shared their current responses in the field for monsoon and COVID-19 affected vulnerable populations. Total 76 participants from provincial government agencies, UN agencies and partner organizations participated in the meeting. Mr. Rijan Gajurel from HRRP is the focal person for the Bagmati province shelter cluster. You can access all the meeting minutes, cluster presentation and other related resources on the Bagmati Shelter Cluster [here](#). For more information, contact Mr. Rijan Gajurel (Hub Coordinator), rijan.gajurel@hrrpnepal.org; mobile number: 9843217112.

COVID-19 live updates from Ministry of Health and Population (MoHP)

According to the Ministry of Health & Population (MOHP) [website](#) data, as of 28 September 2020, total cumulative new cases are 73,384 (male-53,600 and female-19,794), out of which 19,019 confirmed cases are undergoing medical treatment in isolation and 53,818 are discharged after recovery. So far 477 have died due to COVID-19 in Nepal. There are a total of 6,281 in quarantine facilities.

The MoHP has operationalized two call centers **1115 (from 6 am to 10 pm)** and **1133 (24 hours)** since 13 March 2020 (30 Falgun 2076) to provide counselling services regarding COVID-19 prevention and treatment.

DISTRICT & MUNICIPAL UPDATES

In **Lalitpur**, based on the geological assessment carried out in 2076 B.S. (2018/2019 AD), 69 households identified as located in hazard-prone areas in different Municipalities have received an additional grant of 200,000 NPR. This amount has been provided to purchase land in other safer locations under the NRA relocation plan, as those houses were located in geologically hazard-prone areas. Other works like MIS compliance, data verification and updates have been ongoing in **Lalitpur** and **Bhaktapur**, while no tranche disbursement activities have been done in both the districts since mid August (Shrawan 2077 B.S.).

In **Kathmandu**, a virtual meeting was conducted on 7 September 2020 by the DLPIU building to discuss the monthly progress of inspection digitization, and any issues and challenges related to the process. DLPIU had provided a target to carry out inspection digitization to each Municipality during the lockdown period. However, it has been reported that only 12.16% of first and second tranches and 28.10% of third tranche inspection digitization have been completed. The major issues reported in digitization were the unknown status of the compliant files that have been forwarded to DLPIU GMaLI for the release of the remaining tranches. As the tranche has not been released since the end of Asar 2077 B.S., focal engineers are finding it difficult to keep track of the files submitted to DLPIU-Building. Thus, MIS Specialist and HRRP have been requested to find the status of the files forwarded for the release of tranches. Further, focal engineers were requested to continue with the digitization of all compliant files forwarded to DLPIU Building irrespective of the tranche release status. DLPIU-GMaLI is tracking duplication and double payment from Partner Organizations (POs) supported beneficiaries and they are requesting them to return the tranche. Tranche duplication tracking of 10 beneficiaries from Chandragiri Municipality-4 and Gokarneshwor Municipality-6 supported by PO has been completed. In this regard, the respective ward offices and beneficiaries have been contacted. With support from the technical staff, DLPU-GMaLI is collecting the missing PA number within the Kathmandu district from banks and other stakeholders. DLPIU-Building has mobilized the social mobilizer and the mobile masons to track details of the beneficiaries who did not sign the grant agreement but received first or second tranche and also halt the reconstruction process. All the details of the beneficiaries are requested to be collected

before 1 October 2020. The District Support Engineer (DSE) has led the inspection of the first, second and third tranche files of all municipalities of Kathmandu. The deadline for the legal appeal has started, & those enlisted as non-beneficiaries or the beneficiaries who were left in the re-survey or re-verification process, are allowed to go through the legal process and shall be notified before the end of Ashwin 2077 (16 October 2020). So far, 162 beneficiaries have requested to change from retrofitting to reconstruction and vice-versa.

In **Makwanpur**, District coordination and District facilitation meetings were held on 16 September 2020. On the basis of documents and the approval from ward offices the coordination meeting approved the decision for 237 HHs that wanted to continue reconstruction in the same location, where they have been staying for many generations and did not want to be moved somewhere else. During the facilitation meeting, overall private housing reconstruction progress was shared along with reconstruction of other infrastructure.

In **Lamjung**, the district facilitation and coordination meeting was held on 31 August 2020. The major discussions were: temporary arrangement of two technical staff of Sundar Bazar Municipality to Marsyangdi Rural Municipality to cover the gap in regards to providing technical support in the area until DLPIU Building deploys permanent staff. Further, discussion was on collection of beneficiaries details who constructed houses before the deployment of technical staff and had received the second tranche, along with the reasons and/or houses not being compliant and not progressing beyond the second tranche. Households will be approved for the remaining second tranche if correction applied and are compliant as per NRA standard.

HRRP District Coordination Team Bhaktapur, Lalitpur Monthly Report, 27 Aug – 25 Sep 2020



Ward No. 4, Mahankal Rural Municipality, Lalitpur: Single storey, two-roomed Stone in Mud Mortar structure plus attic. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dolakha, Ramechhap, Sindhuli Monthly Report, 27 Aug – 25 Sep 2020



Ward 2, Kamalamai Municipality, Sindhuli: Single storey, two-roomed Brick in Cement Mortar. The homeowner is enlisted in the NRA vulnerable list. Swiss Contact Reconstruction Project (SSRP) provided a top-up amount of 50,000 NPR along with the masons for the reconstruction. The homeowner has received a second tranche of the government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dhading, Gorkha Monthly Report, 27 Aug – 25 Sep 2020



Ward 1, Siddhalekh Rural Municipality, Dhading: SMM single story house with CGI roofing. The house reconstruction is completed and the homeowner has received all three tranches of the government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu Monthly Report, 27 Aug – 25 Sep 2020



Ward 4, Gokarneshwor Municipality, Kathmandu: One storey load bearing brick in cement mortar structure with CGI roof . The house owner has applied for the third tranche and is awaiting it.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok Monthly Report, 27 Aug – 25 Sep 2020



Ward 4, Banepa Municipality, Kavrepalanchok BMC interlocking block. House construction has been completed. The house owner has received all the three tranches from the government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Makwanpur Monthly Report, 27 Aug – 25 Sep 2020



Ward 6, Raksirang Rural Municipality, Makwanpur: Load bearing stone in mud mortar. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team and Lamjung Cluster Monthly Report, 27 Aug – 25 Sep 2020



Ward 3, Dordi Rural Municipality, Lamjung: Single storey stone masonry in cement mortar house is under construction, wherein D.P.C construction is completed and the DLPIU has provided a recommendation for the second tranche. The homeowner has planned to construct a two-roomed house.

HRRP District Coordination Team and Solukhumbu Cluster Monthly Report, 27 Aug – 25 Sep 2020



Ward-4, Necha salyan Rural Municipality, Solukhumbu: SMM house with RCC band. The house owner received all three tranches and has also received a house completion certificate.

FEATURED STORY



Anupa Basnet, Financial Management Specialist: Anupa Basnet has been serving as the Finance Management Specialist for the Earthquake Housing Reconstruction Project at CLPIU under the National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) since 2018. She is recognized for her dedicated works towards prompt channelization of the tranche received through the government and the financial institutions. However, easy channelization of the grants was not an easy job.

When she took charge as the Finance Management Specialist, the government was often criticized for the lengthy grant distribution process, delay in payments, double payment, and more.

As informed by her, 74 bank branches were involved in the grant distribution. However, banks were less concerned about the NRA MIS system. Her team dealt with those hardships creatively; at first, they did a series of consultation meetings with central banks and their branches, and also conducted orientations and workshops. She shares that regular visits and follow up with banks and financial institutions has also helped in reducing gaps and errors in the DLPIU Payment Service Provider (PSP) data. She also managed the issues of the *unpaid grant* and *double payment* tactfully. For *unpaid grants*, an SMS system was established to reach directly to the beneficiaries who haven't even taken their first tranches. The beneficiaries received an SMS reconfirming their eligibility for the reconstruction grant and thereby encouraging them to reconstruct their houses and apply for the tranches. The initiation resulted in many beneficiaries visiting the NRA offices at the district level to access the government tranches and re engage in the reconstruction, while some beneficiaries — who had no intention to reconstruct — returned the grant.

Complaints on some beneficiaries receiving a grant from both government and partner organizations – *double payment* - were also reported at that time. She teamed up with three partner organizations of Kathmandu district to resolve the problem of double payment. So far, NPR 2,500,000 grant amounts were recovered. She expresses her gratitude to the support received from the “Housing Reconstruction and Recovery Platform” for validating the information on grant payment by the government and the partner organization that contributed to the identification and resolution of such cases.

The hard work and dedication of her team to reach out to the distressed and vulnerable community affected by the earthquake have resulted positively due to which the grant payment process is on pace and banks are uploading payment data in the NRA MIS system

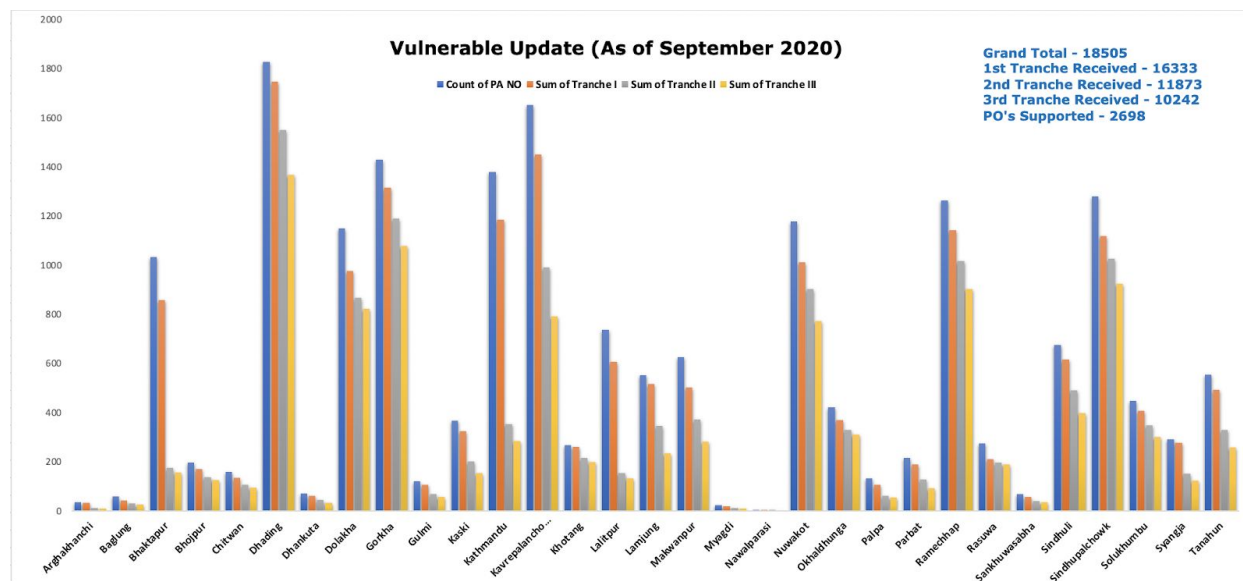
on the time. She, finally, said that proper communication and coordination with primary and secondary stakeholders have helped to settle down any issues incurred while performing the job.

Households Grant Type Conversion

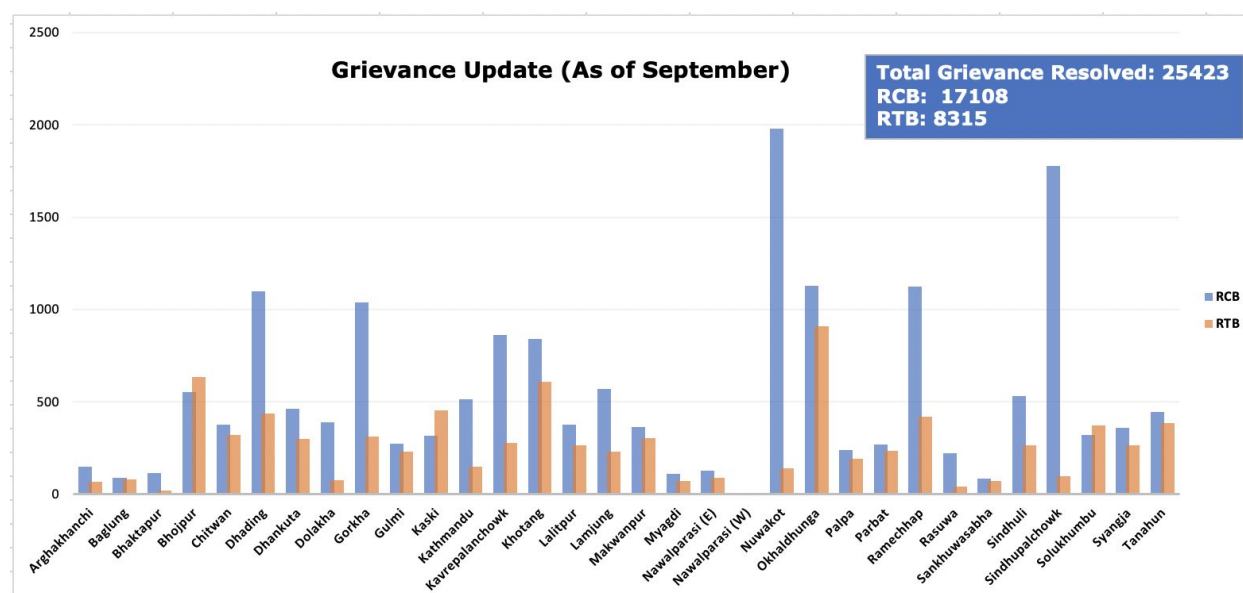
Number of households switching to grant type (September 2020): This data has been collected from the DLPIU offices by the HRRP District Coordination Teams. It will be updated as more information is received.

District	No. of Beneficiaries changed from Retrofitting to Reconstruction	No. of Beneficiaries changed from Reconstruction to Retrofitting
DHADING	7	
DHANKUTA	25	0
DOLAKHA	47	11
GORKHA	71	0
KAVREPALANCHOK	154	5
KATHMANDU	96	66
KHOTANG	4	0
LALITPUR	16	
MAKAWANPUR	219	17
NUWAKOT	27	3
OKHALDHUNGA	22	0
RAMECHHAP	2	0
RASUWA	39	0
SANKHUWASABHA	8	3
SINDHUPALCHOK	24	0
SYANGJA	2	3
Total	763	108

Vulnerable Households Reconstruction (September 2020): Of the total 18,505 NRA identified vulnerable households, 88% (16,333) have received the first tranche, 64% (11,873) have received second tranche and 55% (10,242) have received third tranche. In total 2,698 HHs have been supported by various partner organizations.



Grievance Update: As of 28 September 2020 , **25,423** grievances have been addressed by NRA of which **17,108** HHs have been enlisted as reconstruction beneficiaries and **8,315** as retrofitting beneficiaries.



MEDIA COVERAGE & COMMUNICATION ON RECONSTRUCTION



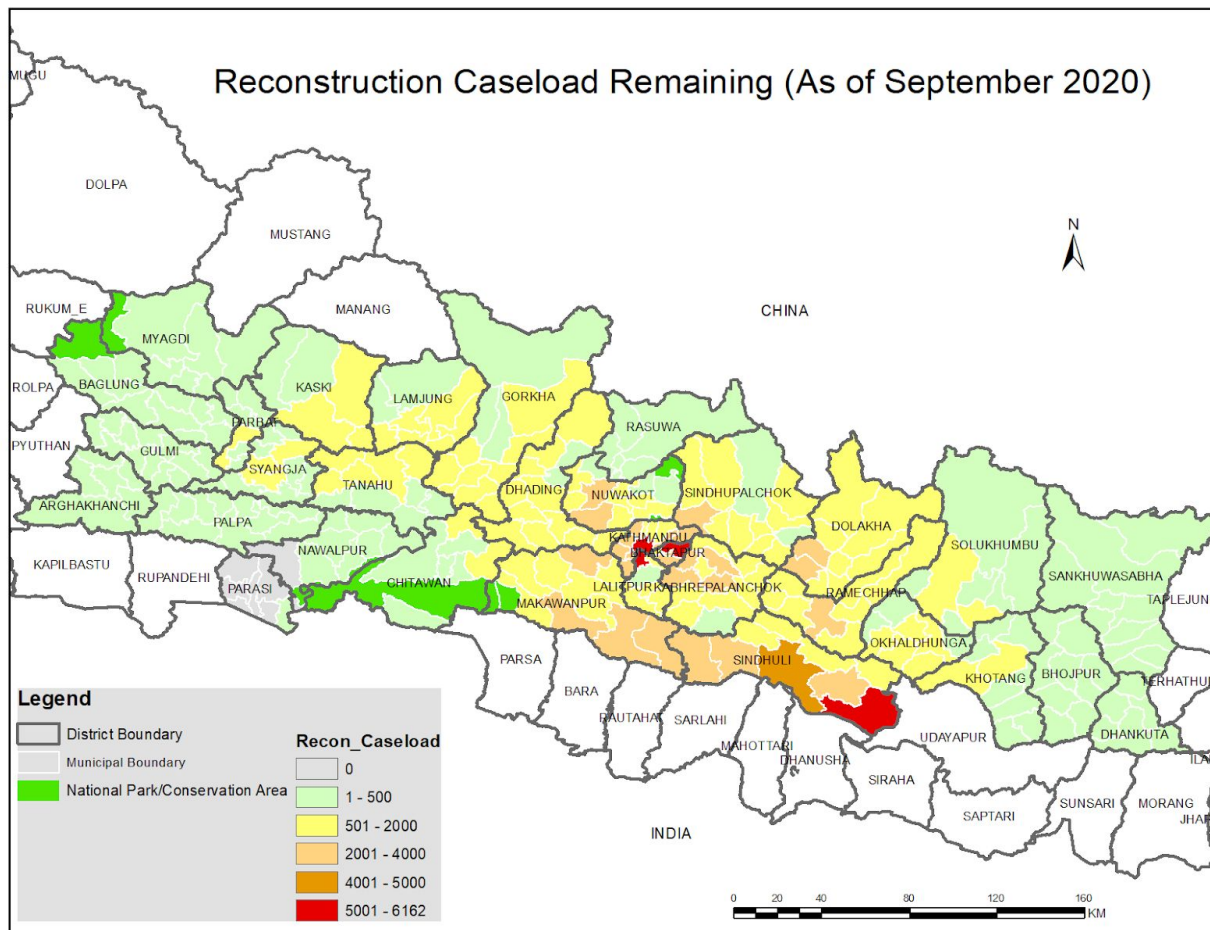
[Baliyo Ghar Surakshit Nepal | 27 September 2020](#): This episode focused on reconstruction progress and challenges in Lurpung, Roshi Rural Municipality-5 in Kavrepalanchowk district. This program was aired on Kantipur Television on 27 September at 6:30 & 10:00 PM.

NATIONAL PRODUCTS

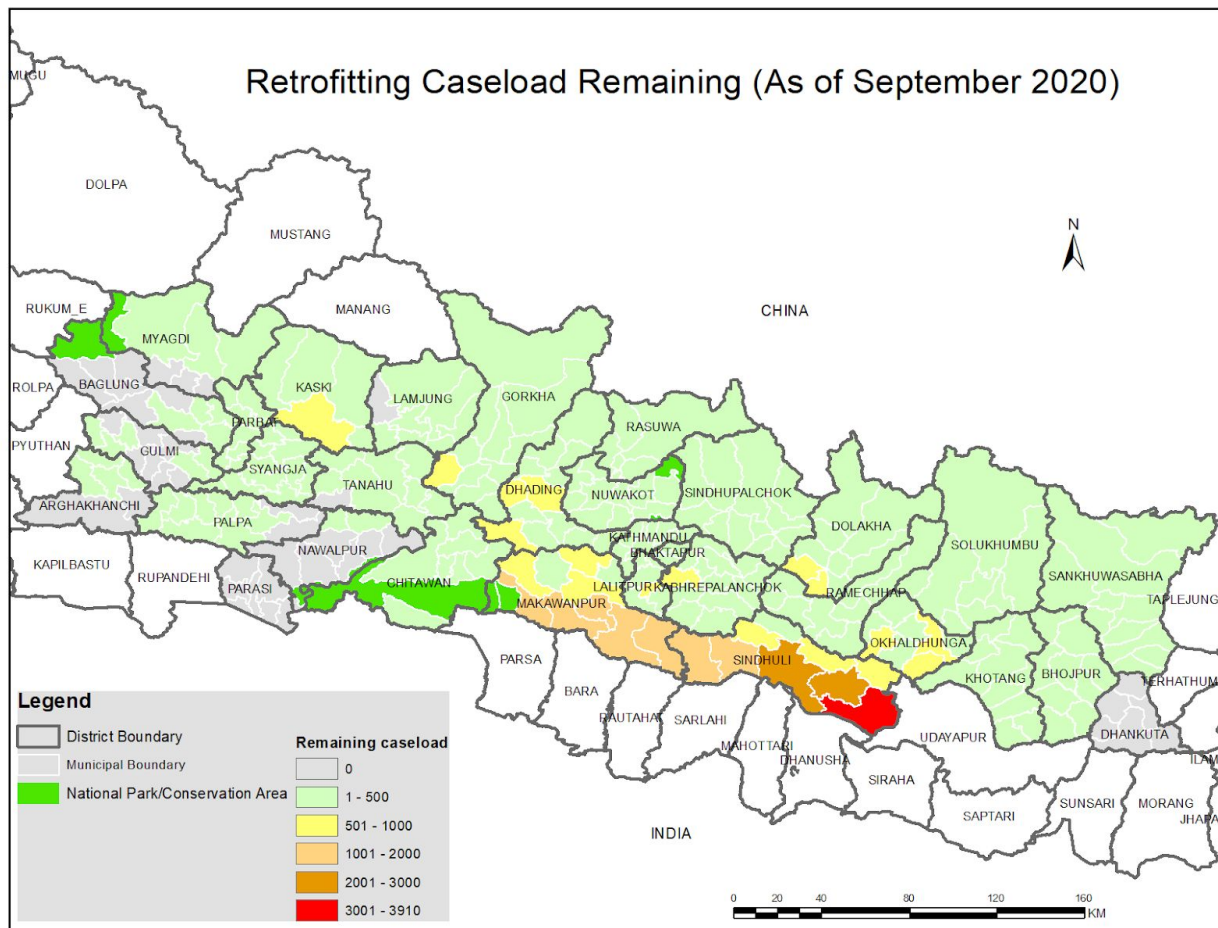
[Monthly e-newsletter of NRA August 2020](#)

HRRP PRODUCTS

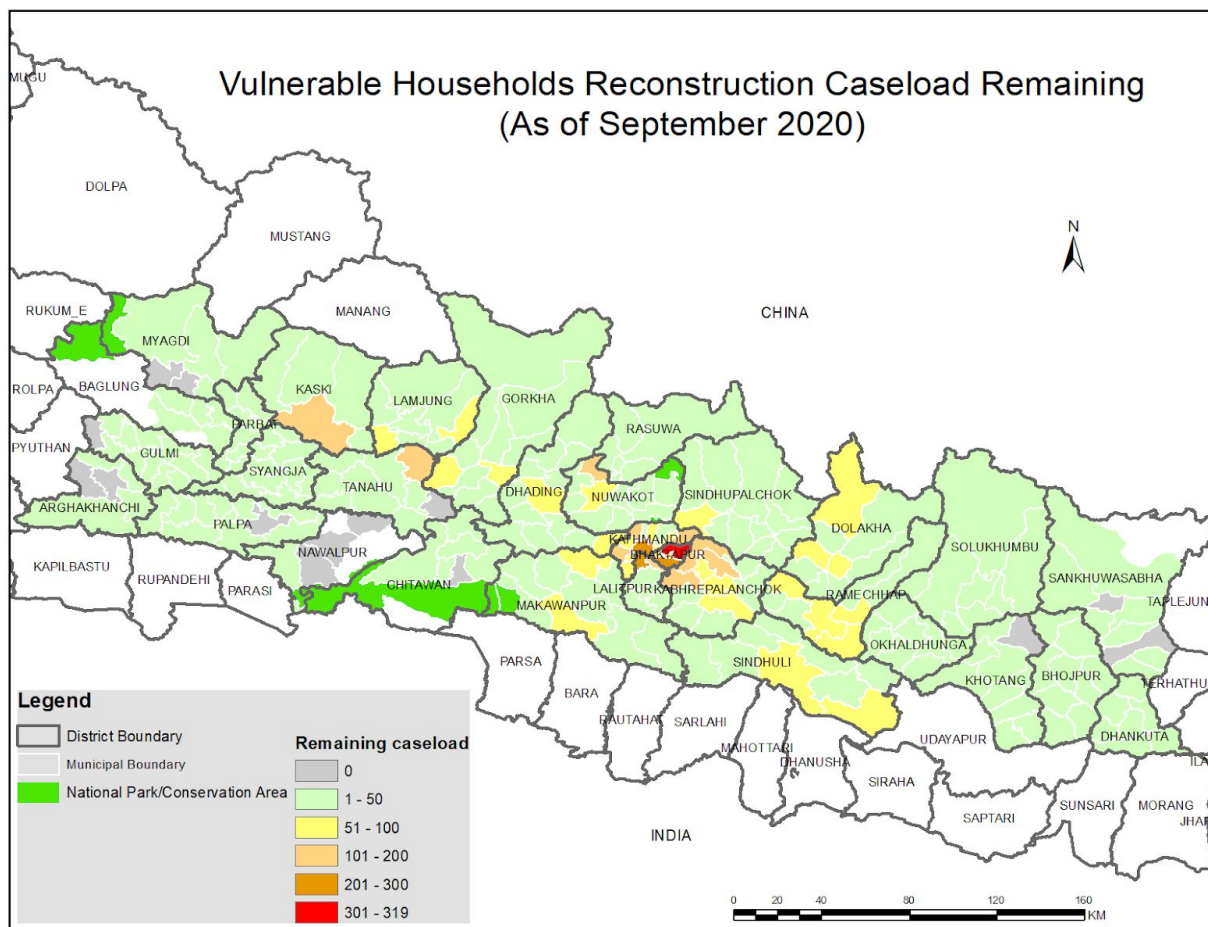
Reconstruction Caseload Remaining (As of September 2020)



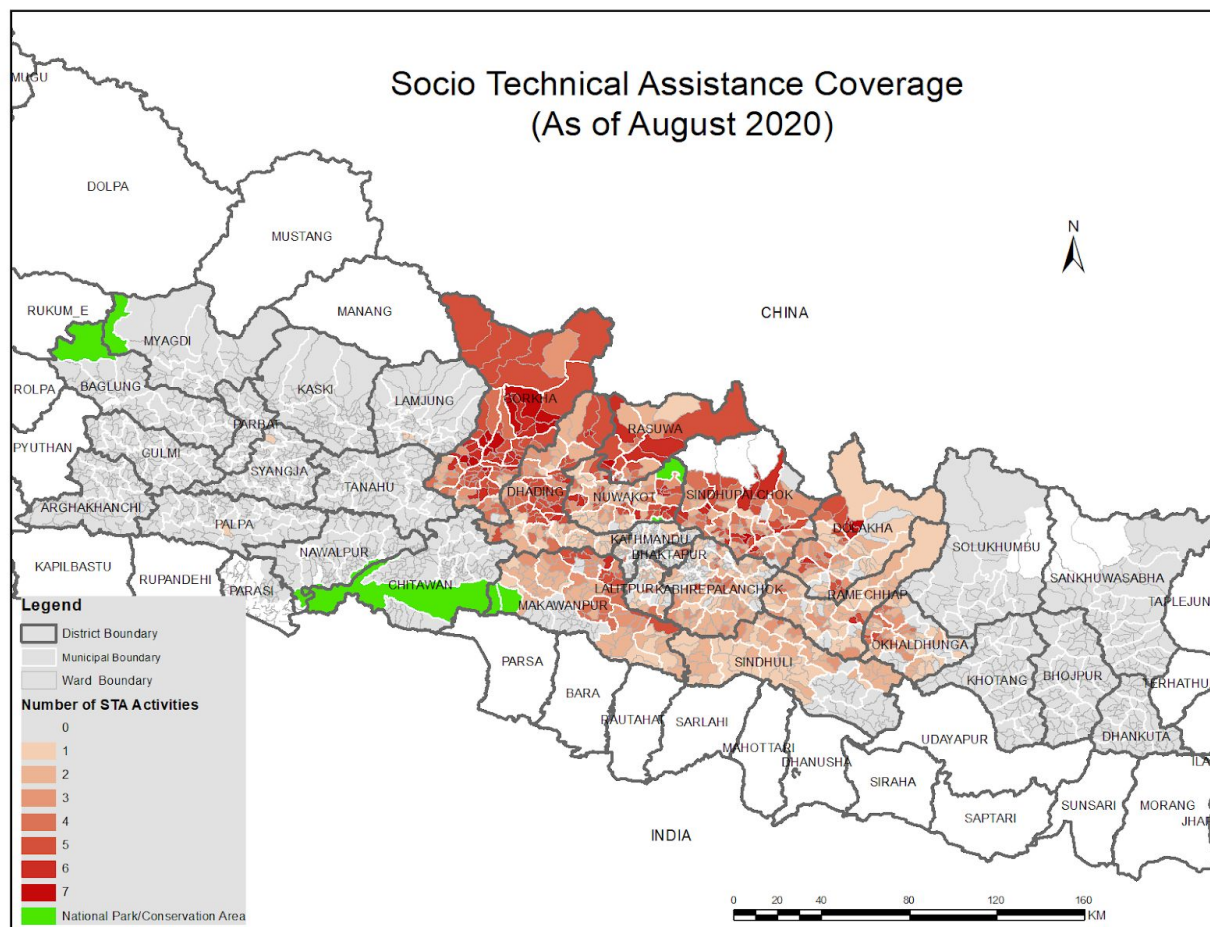
Retrofitting Caseload Remaining (As of September 2020)



Vulnerable Households Reconstruction Caseload Remaining (As of September 2020)



Coverage of Socio Technical Assistance (August 2020)



[Palika Profiles \(Municipal reconstruction profiles\)](#)

The recovery profiles contain various updates on the reconstruction and recovery at the Municipal level for all 282 earthquake-affected municipalities. The municipalities are updating the profiles on a monthly basis with technical support from HRRP.



[Reconstruction and Retrofitting Information Pack](#)

This highlights the reconstruction and retrofitting progress in all 32 earthquake-affected districts at the municipal level. This data is updated by HRRP district staff in close coordination with municipal focal persons. The links will be automatically updated to provide



[Municipal dataset on Reconstruction](#)

[CSV, PDF](#)

A composite dataset for 282 municipalities (urban status, damage grade, reconstruction, retrofitting and vulnerable HHs as identified by NRA can be assessed here as CSV and PDF). The dataset is updated by the municipalities with support from HRRP.

the reconstruction snapshot (PDF)
for the month.

PARTNER PRODUCTS

[HAMI](#): Humanitarian Accountability Monitoring Initiative (HAMI), with the support from OXFAM Nepal, published a [report entitled “Why Invest more on Health and WASH”](#) this week. This report is the assessment carried out in Kapilvastu, Surkhet and Rautahat districts on the existing situation of the availability of health and WASH services and their effect on the public, particularly women, children and persons with disability in times of COVID-19. The report provides recommendations for all three levels of governments in Nepal to take necessary steps to contain the spread and impact of the COVID-19 and build resilient communities to cope with crisis in future.

[FAQs](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [5W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)



CONTACT US

HRRP Nepal Office

Jawagal, Lalitpur, Nepal

Tel: (+977) - 01 - 5544149

Email: info@hrrpnepal.org

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